KERN COUNTY / County Clerk Elections

Aimee X. Espinoza
AUDITOR-CONTROLLER-COUNTY CLERK

Ballot Measure Primary Argument Submission Form

A ballot argument will not be accepted unless accompanied by this completed **typed** form, which shall contain the printed name(s) and signature(s) of the person(s) submitting it or, if submitted on behalf of a bona fide association of citizens, the name of the association and the printed name and signature of at least one of its principal officers. **Please make sure you are using proper format before submitting to the Elections Division.**

Word count limit = 300 words Word count limit for Primary Arguments = 300 words

Ballot Measure Z for the General Election to be held on November 3, 2026

● Primary Argument in Favor ☐ Primary Argument Against ☐ Rebuttal to Argument ☐ Rebuttal to Argument Against

This Argument is Submitted by (check only one):

☐	**The Kern County Board of Supervisors or the Governing Body of a School or Special District**	
	Name of Governing Body:	
	Contact Person's Printed Name:	
	Phone:	Email:
☐	**Member(s) of the Kern County Board of Supervisors or the Governing Body of a School or Special District**	
	Name of Governing Body:	
	Contact Person's Printed Name:	
	Phone:	Email:
☐	**Bona Fide Association of Citizens** If this argument is filed by a bona fide association of citizens, the signer of the argument must be affiliated with the association and be authorized to sign the argument on its behalf. Provide the printed name and signature of at least one principal officer of the association	
	Name of Association:	
	Contact Person's Printed Name:	
	Phone:	Email:
☐	**Individual Voters Eligible to Vote on the Measure**	
	Contact Person's Printed Name:	
	Phone:	Email:
●	**Combination of Voters and Associations**	
	Contact Person's Printed Name: KC Jenkins	
	Phone: 916-442-7757	Email: kcjenkins@bmhlaw.com

GROUNDED & BOUNDLESS

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Primary Argument Signers Form			Author	Verified
No more than five signatures shall appear with any argument. If more than five signatures are submitted, the first five listed shall be printed. Names and titles listed will be printed in the order that they are listed below. Place a checkmark in the author column if the signer is author of the argument. A signer can only list one title. Honorifics such as M.D., Dr., Esquire, etc. with a name are not accepted. If the signers are part of a bona fide association, there is no requirement that they be eligible to vote on the measure. However, for each such signing individual, the title under the signer's name must list the name of that bona fide association and may include their position within that association. By signing below, the undersigned state that they have read the argument and believe it not to be false or misleading. **Type** information clearly.			Check if the signer is the author of the argument. Authors must be signers.	(FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY) Staff Initial once the eligibility of the signer is verified.
1. Name: Dick Taylor		Title: KC Veterans Services Director & US Marine, retired	X	
Phone: 661-332-8394		Email: rdtusmc@msn.com	For translation purposes only	
Address:			He/His: ☒	
Signature:		Date: 8-11-26	She/Her: ☐	
2. Name: Jim Damian		Title: Business Owner	X	
Phone: 510 499 0907		Email: JimD@Lineau.com	For translation purposes only	
Address:			He/His: ☒	
Signature:		Date: 8-11-26	She/Her: ☐	
3. Name: Madelyn Janssen		Title: Former KGET News Anchor	X	
Phone:		Email:	For translation purposes only	
Address:			He/His: ☐	
Signature:		Date: 8/11/26	She/Her: ☒	
4. Name: Stephen L. Sanders		Title: Secretary/Treasurer, CALM Zoo Foundation	X	
Phone: (661) 636-4262		Email: sandersirie@gmail.com	For translation purposes only	
Address:			He/His: ☒	
Signature:		Date: 8-11-26	She/Her: ☐	
5. Name: Lyle Martin		Title: Former Bakersfield Police Chief	X	
Phone: (661) 428-7133		Email: [illegible]	For translation purposes only	
Address:			He/His: ☒	
Sign		Date: 8/11/26	She/Her: ☐	

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Argument in Favor of Measure Z

For more than 40 years, CALM Zoo has been a cherished part of Kern County, where countless children get hands-on experience with California's native wildlife for the first time. But CALM Zoo was built entirely by volunteers and now much of the infrastructure needs repair and maintenance and many of the animal exhibits are out of date and too small.

Measure Z helps CALM Zoo reach its next chapter by implementing a Master Plan to help the Zoo better care for animals and visitors: repairing and improving to animal exhibits, protecting them from extreme heat, improving wildfire/disaster preparedness, repairing roofs, electric and sewer systems, removing asbestos, mold and lead paint.

Yes on Measure Z will expand exhibits so animals have more room to roam in environments that mimic their natural habitats, improve veterinary facilities, conservation efforts, and educational opportunities, and experiences for guests.

CALM Zoo is one of few affordable educational experiences left for Kern County families. Measure Z keeps entrance fees low and continues free/discounted educational field trips for schoolchildren throughout Kern County.

By law, every dollar must remain dedicated to CALM Zoo improvements and cannot be taken or diverted to other purposes. Public spending disclosure, independent oversight and audits ensure accountability and transparency.

The cost: just one penny for every eight dollars spent.

The Zoo's animals depend on our community's continued support to receive the care they deserve. Measure Z ensures the Zoo can meet the basic needs of its animals—engaging habitats, exercise, nutritious food, heating, and cooling—while upgrading facilities for lifelong care and expanding programs to rescue and rehabilitate injured animals.

For more than four decades, CALM Zoo has cared for California wildlife, educated our children, and provided affordable family experiences for our community. Now it's our turn to invest in its future!

Vote YES on Measure Z.

Dick Taylor, KC Veterans Services Director & US Marine, retired

Jim Damian, Business Owner

Maddie Janssen, Former KGET News Anchor

Steve Sanders, Secretary/Treasurer, CALM Zoo Foundation

Lyle Martin, Former Bakersfield Police Chief